

Empiricism — MCQ Solutions

Philosophy Optional | Paper I | Western Philosophy | Topic 03

Open only after attempting the corresponding question. Each solution preserves the complete canonical answer, four option explanations and the examiner trap.

MCQ SOLUTION INDEX

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MCQ 1. What the empiricist rule actually asserts

Consider the following statements about British empiricism as Locke, Berkeley and Hume hold it.

1. Every simple cognitive content must be traceable to experience, which includes inner awareness of the mind's own operations.
2. The mind's operations of comparing, combining and abstracting are themselves denied, since they are not derived from sensation.
3. No proposition whatever can be known independently of experience.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: statement 2 inverts the doctrine, because Locke's whole account of complex ideas depends on the understanding actively combining and comparing what sensation supplies. - **B:** Incorrect: it retains the denial of mental operations and adds a blanket rejection of a priori knowledge that Hume's own class of relations of ideas immediately contradicts. - **C:** Correct: the rule governs the **origin of simple content** and expressly includes reflection, while leaving both the mind's operations and Hume's relations of ideas untouched. - **D:** Incorrect: accepting all three converts a thesis about where materials come from into a general hostility to reason that none of the three empiricists holds.

Examiner trap 1: Defining empiricism as hostility to reason is the commonest opening error in this item. Define it by the **origin of simple content**, and the answer stays on the printed syllabus from the first line.

MCQ 2. Locke's grounds for rejecting innate ideas

Which one of the following is **not** among the grounds Locke advances in Book I of the *Essay* against innate ideas?

- A. If certain ideas were innate, every human being including children would possess them, which they manifestly do not.
- B. A thought that the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind.
- C. Every idea alleged to be innate can be shown to arise instead through sensation or reflection.
- D. Innate ideas would have to be lodged in a material substratum whose nature is entirely unknown to us.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because the failure of universal assent is Locke's opening empirical ground against the innatist appeal to universal agreement. - **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because the impossibility of an unperceived idea is Locke's second and philosophically decisive ground. - **C:** Incorrect as an answer, because the availability of a genetic account is the redundancy argument that makes the innate hypothesis idle. - **D:** Correct: the substratum belongs to Book II's account of substance and plays no part whatever in the anti-innatist argument of Book I.

Examiner trap 2: Candidates import the "something I know not what" from the discussion of substance into the discussion of innate ideas. Keep Book I and Book II separate, because the examiner's marking scheme does.

MCQ 3. Which ground does the decisive work

Locke's refutation of innate ideas is strongest against the dispositional innatism Descartes actually held only if one accepts his premise that

- A. to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind, so an unnoticed idea is a contradiction
- B. children and the cognitively impaired demonstrably lack all of the alleged innate content
- C. the mind at birth is white paper, void of all characters, upon which experience writes
- D. every idea has in fact been traced back to some corresponding act of sensation or reflection

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: only this premise blocks the dispositional retreat, and it is a stipulation about the meaning of "idea" rather than an empirical finding. - **B:** Incorrect: the empirical observation is compatible with innate ideas that are capacities awaiting an occasion, which is exactly Descartes' position. - **C:** Incorrect: the blank-page image states Locke's conclusion about content and cannot function as the premise that establishes it. - **D:** Incorrect: a completed genetic account would show innateness unnecessary, but the dispositional innatist can accept the genesis and still claim a native capacity.

Examiner trap 3: Scripts that give only the children-and-idiots argument have chosen Locke's weakest ground. Name the premise about what "in the mind" means, and then say honestly that it is a stipulation.

MCQ 4. Sorting Locke's complex ideas

Match each of Locke's three kinds of complex idea with its correct description.

1. Modes — 2. Substances — 3. Relations

I. Supposed independently existing bearers, represented through clusters of co-occurring qualities. II. Dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number. III. Ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause or identity.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1–II, 2–I, 3–III

B. 1–I, 2–III, 3–II

C. 1–III, 2–II, 3–I

D. 1–II, 2–III, 3–I

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: modes are dependent combinations, substances are supposed bearers represented through quality-clusters, and relations arise from comparison. - **B:** Incorrect: it makes modes into supposed bearers, which would leave Locke without any category for triangle, gratitude or number. - **C:** Incorrect: it turns modes into comparative ideas and substances into dependent combinations, dissolving the distinction Locke needs for Book III. - **D:** Incorrect: it keeps modes right but exchanges substances and relations, so that "gold" becomes a comparison and "cause" becomes a bearer.

Examiner trap 4: Listing the three kinds without noticing that **substance appears here as a complex idea** wastes the classification's real payload — the admission that we have a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.

MCQ 5. The three degrees of knowledge

Match each degree of Lockean knowledge with the case it certifies.

1. Intuitive — 2. Demonstrative — 3. Sensitive

I. The existence of a particular thing now affecting the senses. II. The existence of God, established through intervening ideas. III. That white is not black, seen immediately without a middle term.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1–I, 2–III, 3–II

B. 1–III, 2–II, 3–I

C. 1–II, 2–I, 3–III

D. 1–III, 2–I, 3–II

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it assigns immediate certainty to particular existents and relegates the self-evident case to the middle rank, inverting Locke's own ordering. - **B:** Correct: intuition is immediate, demonstration proceeds through intervening ideas, and sensitive knowledge concerns particular things now present to sense. - **C:** Incorrect: it makes God intuitively known, which Locke expressly denies, and demotes the existence of present things to demonstration. - **D:** Incorrect: it starts correctly but then treats particular existents as demonstrated and God as sensed, which reverses the two lower degrees.

Examiner trap 5: The examinable point is not the list but the **placement of the external world at the weakest degree**. Say that, and the instability Berkeley exploits becomes visible in your own answer rather than in the examiner's comment.

MCQ 6. Locke's account of general words

According to *Essay* III.iii, an idea becomes general when the mind

- A. discovers a universal subsisting outside the mind and then forms an exact copy of it
- B. selects one particular idea and resolves to let it stand for all the others of that sort
- C. compares two particulars and perceives the relation that holds between them in reality
- D. separates it from the circumstances of time and place and from every concomitant idea

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Locke expressly denies that general and universal belong to the real existence of things, calling them inventions and creatures of the understanding. - **B:** Incorrect: making a determinate particular stand for a class is Berkeley's replacement doctrine at *Principles* Introduction §12, offered against Locke. - **C:** Incorrect: comparison yields ideas of relation, which is a different category of complex idea and does not explain generality. - **D:** Correct: abstraction is separation from circumstances of time, place and concomitants, leaving an idea that serves as a general representative of the sort.

Examiner trap 6: Attributing selective attention to Locke silently hands him Berkeley's solution and leaves the 2025 question with no dispute to explain. Keep **subtraction** with Locke and **selection** with Berkeley.

MCQ 7. Nominal and real essence

Consider the following statements about Locke's two essences.

1. The nominal essence of gold is the abstract idea annexed to the name, such as being yellow, heavy, malleable and soluble in aqua regia.
2. The real essence is the internal constitution from which the observable properties flow, and we generally do not know it.
3. Classification of things into sorts proceeds by real essence, which is why our species divisions track nature exactly.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: nominal essence is the known idea attached to the name and real essence is the unknown internal constitution, and only the first can do classificatory work. - **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 contradicts Locke's central claim that sorting is the workmanship of the understanding rather than a reading-off of nature. - **C:** Incorrect: it correctly describes real essence but then makes it the basis of

classification, which would require the very knowledge Locke says we lack. - **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 alongside the other two makes Locke both agnostic about real essences and dependent on them for sorting.

Examiner trap 7: Writing that Locke "denies real essences" is as wrong as writing that we classify by them. He affirms that things have internal constitutions and denies that we know them.

MCQ 8. What Locke means by a secondary quality

For Locke, the sweetness of a lump of sugar is best described as

- A. an idea existing only in the mind, with nothing at all in the sugar corresponding to it
- B. a power in the sugar, grounded in its primary-quality configuration, to produce a sensation
- C. an illusion produced by the imagination when qualities are constantly conjoined in our experience
- D. a primary quality whose resemblance to our idea is guaranteed by the principle of divine veracity

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it drops the crucial word "power" and leaves the object with no basis at all for the sensation, which is Berkeley's position rather than Locke's. - **B:** Correct: secondary qualities are **powers** in the object, arising from primary-quality arrangements acting on our sense-organs. - **C:** Incorrect: fictions produced by constant conjunction belong to Hume's account of substance and necessity, not to Locke's account of qualities. - **D:** Incorrect: sweetness is precisely not a primary quality, and Locke denies that ideas of secondary qualities resemble anything in the object.

Examiner trap 8: "Secondary qualities are subjective" is the sentence that loses the mark. Write "**powers**", because the sugar really does have the power even though our idea resembles nothing in it.

MCQ 9. The substratum in Locke

Which one of the following most accurately states Locke's position on substance at *Essay* II.xxiii.2?

- A. Substance is a self-contradictory abstraction, since being and supporting cannot be combined into any single idea at all.
- B. Substance is directly perceived by the understanding whenever a cluster of qualities is presented together in experience.
- C. Substance is a fiction of the imagination, invented only because the qualities are found to be constantly conjoined.
- D. Substance exists and supports the qualities, but we have no positive idea of its nature and merely suppose a support.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the charge that substance-in-general is an incoherent abstraction is Berkeley's conclusion, drawn against Locke rather than stated by him. - **B:** Incorrect: Locke's whole point is that the cluster is perceived while the supposed support is never presented to sense at all. - **C:** Incorrect: the diagnosis of substance as an imaginative fiction produced by constant conjunction is Hume's verdict, reached by applying the copy principle. - **D:** Correct: Locke affirms existence and denies knowledge of nature, describing the substratum as "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".

Examiner trap 9: The three positions on substance are easy to swap under time pressure. Fix them by their verbs: Locke **supposes**, Berkeley **denies the sense**, Hume **dissolves into a bundle**.

MCQ 10. The prince and the cobbler

Locke's case in which the prince's consciousness comes to inform the cobbler's body is designed to establish that

- A. the identity of a person is fixed throughout by the continued existence of the same immaterial soul
- B. bodily continuity and consciousness must always coincide in any case that could actually occur
- C. memory is merely evidential, so that neither consciousness nor the body settles who the person is
- D. personal identity follows consciousness, while the identity of the human animal follows the organism

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the case is constructed precisely to detach personal identity from sameness of substance, immaterial or material. - **B:** Incorrect: the thought-experiment is valuable because it prises the two apart, and Locke's argument requires that they can in principle diverge. - **C:** Incorrect: Locke does treat memory as the vehicle and evidence, but consciousness remains constitutive, so the person is definitely settled. - **D:** Correct: the person who wakes is the prince and the man who wakes is the cobbler, which separates personal from animal and substantial identity in a single stroke.

Examiner trap 10: Retelling the story without stating the **three-fold distinction** it illustrates turns a decisive argument into an anecdote. Name person, man and substance before you narrate.

MCQ 11. Reid's Brave Officer

The Brave Officer case is directed against Locke's criterion because it shows that

- A. a criterion built on the reach of consciousness need not be transitive, whereas identity is
- B. memories of childhood are frequently unreliable and therefore cannot ground any criterion
- C. consciousness is interrupted every night by dreamless sleep, so no person survives until morning
- D. a person may be punished for an act that he sincerely and permanently fails to remember

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the officer remembers the boy and the general remembers the officer, but the general does not remember the boy, so the relation fails the transitivity that identity requires. - **B:** Incorrect: the objection is formal rather than evidential, and it would succeed even if every remembered episode were perfectly accurate. - **C:** Incorrect: the interruption problem is a distinct objection, answered by appeal to a continuing capacity for appropriation rather than to constant recollection. - **D:** Incorrect: the forensic consequence is a difficulty Locke embraces, since he holds that we are accountable only for what we can appropriate.

Examiner trap 11: Stating the objection without the repair is only half the work. The Lockean answer is **overlapping chains** of consciousness, which restores transitivity at the cost of the simple memory reading.

MCQ 12. How Locke claims to know that God exists

In Locke's classification, the existence of God is known by

- A. intuition, since the idea of a most perfect being contains existence within itself
- B. sensitive knowledge, since the order of the perceived world is immediately given
- C. demonstration, proceeding from one's own existence by way of the causal principle
- D. an innate idea implanted in every mind and elicited on reaching the age of reason

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: an intuitive or definitional route is the ontological strategy, which Locke does not use and which sits ill with his account of ideas. - **B:** Incorrect: sensitive knowledge is reserved for particular things now affecting the senses and could never reach an eternal being. - **C:** Correct: from the intuitive certainty of my own existence, together with the principle that nothing comes from nothing, Locke demonstrates an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being. - **D:** Incorrect: an innate idea of God is one of the candidates Book I explicitly dismisses, so this option contradicts the foundation of Locke's system.

Examiner trap 12: The examinable payoff is the **exposed premise**: the causal principle Locke leans on is exactly what Hume later refuses to certify. Name that link and the comparative question answers itself.

MCQ 13. What Berkeley's attack on abstraction does and does not deny

Consider the following statements about the Introduction to Berkeley's *Principles*.

1. He concedes that we can imagine a hand separately from the body, because such parts could exist apart.
2. He denies that we can frame an idea of extension without any colour or of motion without a determinate speed.
3. He concludes that general words and general reasoning are impossible and must be abandoned.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: statement 3 attributes to Berkeley the destruction of general reasoning, whereas he offers an alternative account of it in the very next section. - **B:** Correct: he permits separation of what could exist apart, denies separation of what could not, and stops precisely there. - **C:** Incorrect: it correctly reports the denial but adds a conclusion Berkeley never draws and which would make his own geometry unintelligible. - **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 turns a targeted attack on abstract ideas into a general scepticism about language that Berkeley expressly rejects.

Examiner trap 13: Berkeley denies **abstract** general ideas, not general ideas. A script that reports him as abolishing generality cannot then explain how the geometer proves anything.

MCQ 14. Berkeley's replacement account of generality

On Berkeley's positive account, an idea is general in virtue of

- A. being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort
- B. having every determinate feature stripped away until only the common nature remains
- C. corresponding to a nominal essence that the understanding annexes to a sortal name
- D. being formed by the imagination out of impressions that resemble one another closely

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: this is the formula of *Principles* Introduction §12, and the geometer's determinate inch-long line proving a theorem about all lines is its illustration. - **B:** Incorrect: stripping determinations is precisely the Lockean abstraction Berkeley has just declared impossible. - **C:** Incorrect: nominal essence is Locke's device, and Berkeley's objection is that no abstract idea is available to be annexed to the name. - **D:** Incorrect: building general ideas out of resembling impressions describes a Humean associationist account rather than Berkeley's doctrine of representative use.

Examiner trap 14: The unpaid bill in Berkeley's account is what fixes the **respect** under which the particular idea represents. Raise it yourself and the answer reads as assessment rather than as reportage.

MCQ 15. Matching Berkeley's arguments for immaterialism

Match each argument with the move that characterises it.

1. Likeness — 2. Parity — 3. Master Argument — 4. Continuity

I. Every relativity consideration Locke accepts against secondary qualities applies to primary ones too. II. The involuntary and law-governed order of sense requires an active spirit of greater power than mine. III. An idea can be like nothing but an idea, so an unperceivable original cannot be resembled. IV. You cannot conceive a body existing unconceived, because in conceiving it you conceive it.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1–III, 2–IV, 3–I, 4–II

B. 1–III, 2–I, 3–IV, 4–II

C. 1–I, 2–III, 3–II, 4–IV

D. 1–IV, 2–I, 3–III, 4–II

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it correctly identifies likeness but then exchanges parity and the Master Argument, so the relativity considerations are attributed to the wrong section. - **B:** Correct: likeness is §8, parity is §§9–15, the Master Argument is §§22–23, and continuity is §§6, 30–33 and 48. - **C:** Incorrect: it treats parity as the likeness principle and continuity as the challenge about conceiving, reversing two independent arguments. - **D:** Incorrect: it assigns the conceivability challenge to the likeness principle, which confuses a semantic point about resemblance with a psychological one about conceiving.

Examiner trap 15: Naming five arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag is the largest single differentiator available on Berkeley. Learn them as **semantic, likeness, parity, master, continuity**.

MCQ 16. The likeness principle and its strongest answer

The most effective reply available to a defender of Locke against the principle that "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" is that

A. structural or mathematical correspondence needs no qualitative likeness, as a map matches terrain

B. divine veracity guarantees that our ideas of primary qualities resemble what causes them

C. the principle is self-refuting, since Berkeley must compare his own ideas with one another in order to state it at all

D. resemblance between an idea and a quality is a brute relation that stands in need of no further defence whatever

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: isomorphism preserves the representational relation while conceding Berkeley's point that a colour can only be like a colour. - **B:** Incorrect: appealing to divine veracity answers the sceptical worry about reliability, not the semantic worry about what likeness could even mean here. -

C: Incorrect: Berkeley compares ideas with ideas throughout, which is exactly what his principle permits, so no self-refutation arises. - **D:** Incorrect: declaring the relation brute concedes that it cannot be explained or checked, which is the objection rather than an answer to it.

Examiner trap 16: Treating the likeness principle as unanswerable produces an unbalanced answer. Concede that the **qualitative** thesis falls and defend the **structural** one; that is where the modern rescue of Locke lives.

MCQ 17. The Master Argument and the objection to it

The standard objection that Berkeley's Master Argument commits a scope or use–mention confusion holds that

- A. Berkeley illegitimately assumes that only spirits can be causes, which no materialist need ever concede
- B. the argument proves far too much, since it would equally show that unperceived numbers cannot exist
- C. what is inconceivable is conceiving of X that it is unconceived, not conceiving that X is unconceived
- D. conceiving a tree is a mental act, and mental acts are ideas, so the tree must itself be an idea too

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: voluntarism is the presupposition of the continuity argument, not of the challenge about conceiving an unconceived body. - **B:** Incorrect: this is a different reductio, and Berkeley would in any case handle abstract objects through his account of representative use. - **C:** Correct: the objection separates the content of the thought from the act of thinking, exactly as one can think about a number nobody has thought about. - **D:** Incorrect: this restates Berkeley's own conclusion rather than objecting to it, and the inference from act to object is precisely what Moore later attacks.

Examiner trap 17: Building a Berkeley answer around the Master Argument alone is risky, because it is the weakest of the five and has a well-known reply. Use it fourth, and give Berkeley's question-begging rejoinder.

MCQ 18. Spirits, notions and the work God performs

Consider the following statements about Berkeley's positive ontology.

1. Spirits are known by notion rather than by idea, because an idea is passive and could never picture an activity.
2. The laws of nature describe stable sequences in a divine language, so regularities function as signs rather than as causes.
3. Berkeley infers God from the passivity of ideas together with the involuntary and orderly arrival of sense-experience.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only

- B. 1, 2 and 3
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it omits the derivation of God, which is the step that turns the ontology from a bare inventory into an argument. - **B:** Correct: all three statements are accurate, and together they show that God is a structural requirement of immaterialism rather than a devotional addition. - **C:** Incorrect: it drops the notion doctrine, without which Berkeley cannot claim to know spirits at all on his own principles. - **D:** Incorrect: it omits the account of natural law, which is what allows Berkeley to answer the objection that immaterialism destroys science.

Examiner trap 18: Presenting God as an afterthought invites the reply that Berkeley is merely pious. Derive him from the **inertness of ideas** and the objection changes from piety to substitution of posits.

MCQ 19. Berkeley's idealism compared with Hegel's

The decisive difference between Berkeley's subjective idealism and Hegel's absolute idealism is that

- A. Berkeley denies the reality of the external world while Hegel affirms it as a moment of the Absolute
- B. Berkeley reaches idealism by dialectic while Hegel reaches it through an analysis of perception
- C. Berkeley treats matter as unknowable while Hegel treats it as fully knowable by natural science
- D. Berkeley's reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, Hegel's the self-development of Spirit

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Berkeley does not deny the external world; he denies material substance and retains sensible things as collections of ideas. - **B:** Incorrect: the methods are exactly reversed, since dialectical development is Hegel's procedure and anti-abstraction is Berkeley's. - **C:** Incorrect: unknowable matter is Locke's substratum, which Berkeley rejects outright rather than adopts. - **D:** Correct: one is a theistic subjective idealism resting on perception, the other an objective idealism in which objectivity is a moment within self-developing Spirit.

Examiner trap 19: Calling Berkeley "an early Hegel" is a category error the 2024 paper is designed to detect. The two differ **in kind**, not in degree, and the answer must say so explicitly.

MCQ 20. Moore and Russell against Berkeley

The difference between Moore's and Russell's reactions to Berkeley is best stated by saying that

- A. Moore accepts Berkeley's premises but rejects the conclusion, whereas Russell rejects them
- B. Moore defends the ordinary object as directly known, whereas Russell replaces it with a construction

C. Moore relies on the verification principle of meaning, whereas Russell relies on the picture theory of meaning

D. Moore denies the act–object distinction altogether, whereas Russell insists that awareness and object are identical

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Moore's central move is to reject the premise that conflates the act of awareness with its object, so he does not accept Berkeley's premises. - **B:** Correct: Moore's transparency argument supports direct realism, while Russell reconstructs physical objects analytically and keeps only structural objectivity. - **C:** Incorrect: both doctrines named here belong to other syllabus items and to later phases, and neither is deployed against Berkeley in this context. - **D:** Incorrect: it inverts both positions, since it is Moore who insists on the act–object distinction and the idealist who collapses it.

Examiner trap 20: The 2018 question asks a third thing after the two reactions: whether they **differ**. An answer that reports both and never contrasts them has left a whole limb unanswered.

MCQ 21. Impressions, ideas and the missing shade of blue

Consider the following statements about Hume's copy principle.

1. It holds that every simple idea derives from a corresponding simple impression.
2. Hume concedes the missing shade of blue as a case in which a simple idea arises without its antecedent impression.
3. The concession shows that the copy principle is an empirical generalisation rather than an analytic truth.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it omits the consequence that makes the concession worth stating, namely the demotion of the principle to an empirical generalisation. - **B:** Incorrect: it drops the statement of the principle itself, leaving the concession and its consequence without the claim they qualify. - **C:** Correct: all three are accurate, and together they turn a descriptive report of Hume into a critical one. - **D:** Incorrect: it asserts the consequence while omitting the very case that generates it, which leaves the criticism unsupported.

Examiner trap 21: Concede the missing shade **before** the examiner raises it, and supply Hume's reply that the shade is interpolated between impressions actually had, so the principle's spirit survives its letter.

MCQ 22. Placing two propositions inside Hume's fork

For Hume, the propositions " $2+2=4$ " and "The Sun will rise tomorrow" differ because

- A. the first is certain and the second is highly probable, though both are ultimately relations of ideas
- B. the first is a matter of fact whose evidence is overwhelming, the second one whose evidence is weaker
- C. the first is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory, the second a contingent matter of fact
- D. both are matters of fact, differing only in the number of past instances that have so far supported them

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it correctly notes the difference in certainty but then places both propositions in the same box, which erases the fork. - **B:** Incorrect: treating an arithmetical truth as a well-evidenced matter of fact makes its denial merely improbable rather than contradictory. - **C:** Correct: the fork divides a priori necessary relations of ideas from a posteriori contingent matters of fact, and conceivability is the operative test. - **D:** Incorrect: counting instances is irrelevant to a relation of ideas, and this option reduces the distinction to a difference in inductive support.

Examiner trap 22: The 2018 question is built to catch exactly the answer that says both truths are equally necessary or merely differ in probability. Give the **conceivability** test in the first line.

MCQ 23. Substance and the belief in body

Consider the following statements about Hume.

1. He concludes that "substance" is a fiction of the imagination, since no impression of a bearer can be found.
2. The dissolution applies to material substance only, spiritual substance being secured by inner awareness.
3. Constancy and coherence among perceptions lead the imagination to feign continued and distinct bodies.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it retains the false exemption for spiritual substance and omits the general verdict that substance is an imaginative fiction. - **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 is precisely the point at which Hume passes beyond Berkeley, who did retain spirit as an active substance. - **C:** Incorrect: accepting

statement 2 would make Hume's treatment of the self inconsistent with his treatment of body. - **D:** Correct: the copy principle dissolves material and spiritual substance alike, while constancy and coherence explain why we nevertheless believe in continuing bodies.

Examiner trap 23: Writing that Hume "proves there is no external world" reverses his conclusion. He shows that **reason cannot justify** the belief, and then explains why nature makes it unavoidable.

MCQ 24. What Hume finds and does not find in causation

In Hume's analysis, the idea of necessary connexion is copied from

- A. the observed contiguity and temporal priority of the two events considered together in one instance
- B. an innate structure of the understanding that organises perceptions
- C. an impression of reflection: the mind's felt determination to pass from cause to effect
- D. the repeated observation that gives the hundredth collision a quality which the first collision lacked

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: contiguity and priority are genuinely observed, but they are precisely the elements that fall short of any necessity. - **B:** Incorrect: an a priori rule of the understanding is Kant's answer in the Second Analogy, offered against Hume rather than by him. - **C:** Correct: repetition changes the mind rather than the objects, and the felt determination it installs is the internal impression from which the idea is copied. - **D:** Incorrect: Hume insists that repetition adds no new quality to the objects, so the hundredth collision is qualitatively identical to the first.

Examiner trap 24: Stopping at "constant conjunction" gives only the negative half. The positive half — the **impression of reflection** — is what makes the account an explanation rather than a denial.

MCQ 25 (remedial). The two definitions of cause

Hume's two definitions of cause are best characterised as

- A. one objective and regularity-based, the other psychological and framed by the thought conveyed
- B. one applying only to physical events and the other exclusively to acts of the human will
- C. two equivalent formulations that Hume explicitly proves to be interchangeable in every case
- D. an earlier definition given in the *Treatise* which he then formally withdraws in the *Enquiry*

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the first defines a cause as an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed; the second as one whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. - **B:** Incorrect: both definitions are perfectly general, and the discussion of volition is used to close an escape

route rather than to found a second domain. - **C:** Incorrect: the two pull apart rather than coincide, and Hume never demonstrates their equivalence — a tension that generates a modern debate. - **D:** Incorrect: both definitions appear together in *Enquiry* VII, so there is no withdrawal of one in favour of the other.

Examiner trap 25: Giving only one definition is the most expensive omission in this sub-topic. Name **both**, then note that Hume leaves their relation unreconciled.

MCQ 26 (remedial). What the bundle theory denies

Hume's bundle theory of the self is correctly stated as the claim that

- A. the perceptions themselves are fictions, so that nothing whatever exists in the mind at all
- B. personal identity is constituted by the continuity of the living human organism over time
- C. the self is an active spirit whose existence is known by notion rather than by any idea
- D. there is no simple, identical self-substance, although the perceptions are entirely real

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hume never doubts the perceptions; his argument is precisely that they are all introspection delivers. - **B:** Incorrect: an organism-based criterion is Locke's account of the same **man**, which he distinguishes carefully from the person. - **C:** Incorrect: the active spirit known by notion is Berkeley's doctrine, and Hume's dissolution of spiritual substance is directed against it. - **D:** Correct: what is denied is the owner behind the perceptions, and the perceptions in perpetual flux are what remain.

Examiner trap 26: "Hume says the self does not exist" is the sentence that wrecks this answer. Say that **no simple identical substance** is found, and then add the Appendix confession.

MCQ 27 (remedial). Kant's two routed replies

Match each Kantian doctrine with the Humean problem it answers.

1. Transcendental unity of apperception — 2. Second Analogy

I. The absence of any source impression for necessary connexion between events. II. The absence of any constant and invariable impression of a continuing self.

Which of the following statements is correct?

- A. 1 answers I, and 2 answers II, since apperception concerns events and the Analogy concerns the subject
- B. Neither answers a Humean problem, since Kant rejects the copy principle
- C. Both answer II, since apperception and the Analogy are two names for the same doctrine of unity
- D. 1 answers II, and 2 answers I, and in both cases Kant accepts Hume's negative finding

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it reverses the pairing, attaching the unity of the subject to the analysis of events and the causal rule to self-consciousness. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant expressly agrees that no impression yields a soul-substance or a necessary connexion, and builds his reply on that agreement. - **C:** Incorrect: they are distinct doctrines with distinct arguments, one concerning the unity of experience and the other the objectivity of succession. - **D:** Correct: apperception addresses the missing unity of the self and the Second Analogy the missing necessity in causation, in each case by supplying a formal condition rather than an observed item.

Examiner trap 27: Reporting Kant as "proving the soul exists" or as "refuting Hume's premise" inverts him. He **accepts** the negative results and attacks the atomism of impressions instead.

MCQ 28 (remedial). Where every reply to the problem of induction must strike

Kant, Popper and Strawson all direct their answers to Hume's induction dilemma at the step which asserts that

- A. all reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory rests on cause and effect
- B. the Uniformity Principle can be established only demonstratively or probably, by no third route
- C. the denial of the Uniformity Principle implies no contradiction and is therefore perfectly conceivable
- D. any experiential argument for the Uniformity Principle already presupposes that very principle

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the dependence of factual inference on causal reasoning is accepted by all three respondents and is not the contested step. - **B:** Correct: the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative-or-probable division is the fork applied reflexively, and each reply breaks it differently. - **C:** Incorrect: the conceivability of nature changing is granted on all sides, and disputing it would require abandoning Hume's account of possibility. - **D:** Incorrect: the circularity of experiential support is the least contested move in the argument and is generally conceded outright.

Examiner trap 28: An answer that attacks a horn of the dilemma without noticing that the **division itself** is Hume's fork has not located the argument's weight-bearing assumption.

MCQ 29 (remedial). Two sentences that must never be written

Consider the following two statements.

1. Berkeley denies the existence of the external world.
2. Hume denies causation.

Which of the following corrects both?

- A. Berkeley denies only unperceived objects, while Hume denies only that causes precede their effects
- B. Berkeley denies sensible things but keeps spirits; Hume denies causal inference but keeps conjunction

- C. Berkeley denies material substance but keeps sensible things; Hume denies objective necessity only
- D. Both statements are accurate summaries of the two positions and are safe to use in an examination

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: unperceived objects persist for Berkeley through divine perception, and temporal priority is one of the elements Hume explicitly retains. - **B:** Incorrect: Berkeley affirms sensible things rather than denying them, and Hume never abandons causal inference, which custom makes unavoidable. - **C:** Correct: each denial is narrower than the slogan, and stating the exact target is what converts a misreading into an accurate account. - **D:** Incorrect: both are examiner-flagged misreadings, and either sentence can cost marks even when the rest of the answer is sound.

Examiner trap 29: These two slogans are the most frequently penalised sentences in the whole item. Replace them with the exact targets: **matter as unperceiving substratum**, and **observable objective necessity**.

MCQ 30 (remedial). Provenance and dating

Consider the following statements about the texts of this syllabus item.

1. "*Tabula rasa*" is Locke's own phrase in the *Essay*.
2. "*Esse est percipi aut percipere*" is Berkeley's own Latin in the *Principles*.
3. The chapter on personal identity was added to the *Essay* in the second edition of 1694.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: only the dating claim is accurate, since Locke writes of "white paper, void of all characters" and Berkeley's own Latin at §3 is *esse est percipi* without the addition. - **B:** Incorrect: both Latin attributions are later labels, one Scholastic in origin and the other a commentators' expansion made to accommodate spirits. - **C:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the *tabula rasa* misattribution, which is the commonest quotation error in this item. - **D:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the expanded Latin formula, which Berkeley never wrote.

Examiner trap 30: Free marks are available for a single provenance clause. Write "the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*" and cite *esse est percipi* at §3 without the expansion.

MCQ 31 (remedial). What this syllabus item does not own

Which one of the following belongs to this syllabus item rather than to another owner?

- A. Quine's argument in "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" against the analytic–synthetic distinction
- B. Kant's transcendental exposition of space and time together with his table of the categories
- C. Hume's account of why we believe in continued bodies despite interrupted perception
- D. Hegel's dialectical method and the movement of determinate negation towards the Absolute

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the *Two Dogmas* material is routed to Quine and Strawson, and sharing the word "empiricism" creates no ownership here. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant's positive system belongs to the next syllabus item and appears here only as the explicitly routed reply on the self and on causation. - **C:** Correct: constancy, coherence and the feigned continuity of bodies are Hume's own doctrine and sit inside the printed clause on substance and scepticism. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegel's method belongs to its own item and enters here only as one term of the comparison the 2024 paper requires.

Examiner trap 31: Importing another owner's doctrine wastes the words a 15-mark answer cannot spare. Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell enter **only** where a routed question names them.

MCQ 32 (remedial). What a comparative answer in this item must contain

- A twenty-mark comparative answer on Locke, Berkeley and Hume earns its marks primarily by
- A. narrating each philosopher's system in turn and closing with a paragraph of general observations
 - B. announcing a single criterion, running matched axes, and ruling on the sequence it produces
 - C. reproducing the chronology of publication so that the historical influences are fully displayed
 - D. listing every objection raised against each thinker without adjudicating between them

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: three parallel summaries display information without explaining the relation the examiner has asked about. - **B:** Correct: a stated criterion converts six separate disagreements into six consequences of one decision, which is exactly what a comparison is for. - **C:** Incorrect: chronology prevents anachronism but does not by itself explain why each successor rejects his predecessor's exemption. - **D:** Incorrect: an unadjudicated list of objections is journalism, and the residual column is where judgement is actually shown.

Examiner trap 32: The comparative mark is awarded for the **mechanism**, not for the coverage. State the criterion in the opening sentence and let the table function as evidence for it.